Lesson 2: Ask Better, Get Better: The 4-Part Prompt

Module 1 | 60 minutes | Role, Task, Context, Format | Adults (18+) · ages 18–65

Objective: Write clear prompts with a Role, Task, Context and Format, improve replies with follow-ups, and build a library of 10 prompts for your own job.

Success criteria

- I can write a prompt with Role, Task, Context and Format.
- I can improve a reply with follow-up messages.
- I can ask the AI to ask me questions first for bigger tasks.
- I can save reusable prompts in my own prompt library.

Key vocabulary

- **Role**: Who you want the AI to act as, like a polite shop helper or an HR assistant.
- **Task**: The exact job: write, reply, translate, summarise.
- **Context**: The background facts the AI cannot know unless you tell it.
- **Format**: The shape of the answer: length, bullets, table, language, tone.
- **follow-up**: A second message that improves the first reply, like “make it shorter”.
- **prompt library**: Your saved, reusable prompts with [brackets] for the parts that change.

You will need

- Projector or screen share with Kitabash and the AI tools for this lesson
- Devices: 1 per learner (laptop, tablet or phone)
- Learner accounts only where allowed: see the course safety notes
- Printed worksheet (optional)
- Project files: l02_prompt_library_kit.md, l02_teacher_demo_script.md

Timed lesson plan (60 min)

Time	Stage	What happens
5 min	**Warm-up game**	“Bad brief, good brief” acting game (see Unplugged).
4 min	**Watch**	Play the lesson video. Pause after the vague prompt: thumbs up or down, would you send it?
6 min	**Live demo**	Vague prompt, then the class builds the 4-part prompt live; follow-ups; “ask me first”; the “kal” translation check.
8 min	**Prompt Lab 1**	Prompt Lab: the 4-part WhatsApp reply. Paste into two tools and compare.

6 min	**Quick competition**	Match the prompt parts and “Better prompt: A or B?” played as a race; first three correct answers win.
7 min	**Prompt Lab 2 (pairs)**	Prompt Lab: ask me questions first. One partner plays the AI and asks the questions; then try it in a real tool.
10 min	**Build along**	Build your prompt library: list writing jobs, write and test prompts in two tools. Teacher circulates.
5 min	**Show-and-tell**	Three learners share their most useful saved prompt and the follow-up they added.
5 min	**Probe**	Improve it with follow-ups (order game) and the “kal” problem (individual).
4 min	**Wrap-up**	Exit ticket and homework; learners complete their library to 10 prompts using the project kit.

Unplugged warm-up

Bad brief, good brief (5 min): one volunteer is the “assistant” and must draw or act out “make me something nice”. Then the class gives a 4-part brief (“You are a sign painter; make a sign for my tea stall; it opens at 7 am; big letters, 3 words”). Ask: what changed?

Teaching the idea

The biggest jump in AI quality comes from the prompt, not the tool. Teach four plain words: Role (who the AI should be), Task (what to make), Context (the facts it cannot guess) and Format (the shape: length, bullets, language). Then show that a prompt is a conversation: follow-ups like “shorter” or “in Hindi” fix most drafts. For bigger tasks, “ask me questions first” makes the AI collect what it needs. Every learner leaves with a personal library of 10 prompts for their own job.

Analogy: Giving a prompt is like briefing a new staff member: “You’re on the counter today (role). Reply to this customer (task). Her order is late because the van broke down (context). Keep it short and friendly (format).”

Live demo: 1) Type “Write a reply to a customer.” in ChatGPT and read the empty, generic answer aloud. 2) Ask the class for the four missing parts and type them in as they call out: Role, Task, Context, Format (use the cooler example). 3) Run it in Claude or Gemini too. 4) Follow up live: “Make it shorter” then “Add one line in Hindi”. 5) Show “Ask me any questions you need before you write” with the PTM notice and answer the questions out loud. 6) Translate “Payment kal tak bhej dunga” and ask the Hindi speakers to check it.

Questions to ask

Ask	Listen for
What are the four parts of a good prompt?	Role, Task, Context, Format.

Which part stops the AI from inventing facts?	Context, because you give it the real facts.
The reply is too long. What do you do?	Send a follow-up: “Make it shorter, under 4 lines.”
When should you say “ask me questions first”?	For bigger or unclear tasks, like a notice, a report or a plan.
Why use [brackets] in saved prompts?	So you can reuse the prompt by filling in only the parts that change.

Differentiation

Support
Give a fill-in card: “You are ___. Write ___ for ___. The facts are ___. Keep it ___.” Learners can speak the prompt using the microphone and edit it after.

Stretch
Write one prompt that produces a reply in English, Hindi and one more Indian language; ask a colleague who speaks it to check the meaning.

Common misconceptions

Misconception	How to fix it
Long prompts confuse the AI.	Clear details help. Long is fine if every line is useful.
If the first answer is bad, the tool is bad.	Improve the prompt or send a follow-up first.
AI translation is always correct.	It can miss meaning (like “kal”). Check if you know the language, or ask someone who does.
I must use special words or English only.	Plain sentences work in English, Hindi or Hinglish.

Assessment

Use the Prompt Lab results (auto-checked), the quick checks and the Probe answers. Written answers arrive in your review queue.

Exit ticket
Write the four parts of a prompt for a message you will send tomorrow.

Homework
Use three prompts from your library at work this week (with placeholders). Improve any prompt that needed many follow-ups, and bring your best before/after.

Answer key — Kitabash activities

1. Prompt Lab: the 4-part WhatsApp reply (perform · ai lab)

Checklist: Role: tell the AI who to be · Task: say exactly what to write · Context: the facts (van broke down, new day) · Format: length, style or language

Strong example:

```
You are a polite customer-care helper for my electronics shop. Write a WhatsApp reply to a customer whose cooler, ordered on Monday, is late because our delivery van broke down. It will now arrive on Friday before 6 pm. Keep it to 3 short lines in simple English and say sorry once.
```

2. Prompt Lab: ask me questions first (perform · ai lab)

Checklist: Role: who the AI should be · Task: a notice, circular or message · Both languages · Ask the AI to ask you questions first · Format: length or layout

Strong example:

```
You are an experienced school coordinator. Write a short notice for parents about next month’s parent-teacher meeting, first in simple English and then in Hindi. Keep each version under 100 words. Ask me any questions you need before you write, such as the date, time and classes.
```

3. Match each part of a prompt to its example (a CA’s assistant writing to clients) (perform · matching)

Role → You are an experienced assistant in a CA office. · Task → Draft a reminder asking clients to send their bills. · Context → The return filing date is close and 12 clients have not sent bills yet. · Format → Make it a WhatsApp message under 50 words.

4. Better prompt: A or B? (perform · multiple choice)

Answer: B, because it gives role, task, context and format

5. Improve it with follow-ups (perform · ordering)

Order: Read the first draft fully → Ask: “Make it shorter, under 4 lines” → Ask: “Make it friendlier, like a WhatsApp message” → Check the facts are still correct → Save the improved prompt in your library

6. New situation: the “kal” problem (probe · multiple choice)

Answer: Check the meaning yourself and fix it to “I will send the payment by tomorrow”, then add context to your prompt next time

Answer key — worksheet

1. **Key words:** Role = Who you want the AI to act as, like a polite shop helper or an HR assistant. · Task = The exact job: write, reply, translate, summarise. · Context = The background facts the AI cannot know unless you tell it. · Format = The shape of the answer: length, bullets, table, language, tone.
2. **Prompt Lab: the 4-part WhatsApp reply:** Include: Role: tell the AI who to be; Task: say exactly what to write; Context: the facts (van broke down, new day); Format: length, style or language. Example: You are a polite customer-care helper for my electronics shop. Write a WhatsApp reply to a customer whose cooler, ordered on Monday, is late because our delivery van broke down. It will now arrive on Friday before 6 pm. Keep it to 3 short lines in simple English and say sorry once.
3. **Prompt Lab: ask me questions first:** Include: Role: who the AI should be; Task: a notice, circular or message; Both languages; Ask the AI to ask you questions first; Format: length or layout. Example: You are an experienced school coordinator. Write a short notice for parents about next month's parent-teacher meeting, first in simple English and then in Hindi. Keep each version under 100 words. Ask me any questions you need before you write, such as the date, time and classes.
4. **Match each part of a prompt to its example (a CA's assistant writing to clients):** Role → You are an experienced assistant in a CA office. · Task → Draft a reminder asking clients to send their bills. · Context → The return filing date is close and 12 clients have not sent bills yet. · Format → Make it a WhatsApp message under 50 words.
5. **Better prompt: A or B?:** B. B, because it gives role, task, context and format — B gives the reader, dates, reason and length, so the first draft is usable. A forces the AI to invent dates and reasons.

Kitabash original curriculum. Product names (ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Canva, NotebookLM, Perplexity, Teachable Machine) belong to their owners; Kitabash is not affiliated with or endorsed by them. Tools and age rules change: check each tool's current terms before class.